Billing Policy

SHIFA General Hospital (Fictional)

DEMO / SYNTHETIC HOSPITAL DATA — NOT FOR REAL CLINICAL USE

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1. Purpose

This policy explains how SHIFA General Hospital charges for services, collects deposits and issues bills. The Billing Office main extension is 1700.

2. Billing Office Hours

- Main Billing Office: every day from 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM.
- Emergency Billing Counter: open 24 hours a day. Patients discharged after 8:00 PM settle dues here.

3. Admission Deposits

A refundable deposit is collected at admission:

- General Ward: PKR 20,000.
- Semi-Private Room: PKR 35,000.
- Private Room: PKR 50,000.
- ICU, CCU and NICU: PKR 100,000.

Deposits for other room types are listed in BF-04. Emergency admissions may defer the deposit for up to 24 hours after the patient is stabilised. No emergency patient is denied stabilising treatment because of inability to pay.

4. Estimates and Bills

- A written cost estimate for a planned procedure is provided within 4 working hours of request.
- An interim bill is shared with the attendant every 24 hours. When charges reach 80 percent of the deposit, the billing staff ask the attendant to top up the deposit.
- The final bill is prepared within 2 hours of the discharge order.

5. Room Charges and Checkout Time

Room charges are per day (see BF-04). Checkout time is 12:00 noon. A patient who leaves after 12:00 noon and up to 6:00 PM is charged a half-day room rate. A patient who leaves after 6:00 PM is charged a full day.

6. Concessions

- Senior citizens aged 65 and above receive 10 percent off OPD consultation fees.
- Hospital employees and their dependents receive 25 percent off non-consumable services (room, consultation and procedures). Medicines and implants are excluded.
- Concessions cannot be combined and do not apply to insurance panel rates.
- Patients who cannot afford treatment may apply to the Patient Welfare Committee through the Billing Supervisor.

7. Billing Disputes

A patient or attendant who disagrees with a bill must raise the complaint with the Billing Supervisor (extension 1701) within 7 days of the final bill. The Billing Supervisor gives a decision within 3 working days.